

IT Asset Management Policy

Meridian Data Services | Policy ITAM-001 | Version 3.3 | Effective 2026-01-01

1. Purpose and scope

This policy establishes accountable custody, movement, return, loss, financial reconciliation, sanitization, and disposal controls for company-owned laptops, monitors, mobile devices, and network equipment.

2. System of record

The IT asset register is the operational system of record for assignment and location. The fixed-asset ledger is the financial system of record for capitalized cost and net book value. Neither file may be updated from verbal claims alone.

3. Evidence precedence (conflicts)

When sources disagree, apply this order and document the conflict: (1) fixed-asset ledger rows, verified disposal certificates, and carrier acceptance/delivery/receiving-scan triples; (2) approved transfers with non-blank approval IDs and received dates; (3) HR employment status; (4) service-desk ticket status fields; (5) technician notes and dock/exception images. Lower-precedence sources are leads only and never override higher-precedence transaction evidence.

4. Assignment and transfer

Assets move only with a transfer ID, non-blank approval ID, and receiving acknowledgment. Blank approval IDs are control exceptions. Closed-office locations are not valid verified locations after consolidation.

5. Offboarding and returns

Separated employees must return assigned assets within 10 business days. A carrier label is not proof of return. Return completion requires carrier acceptance, delivery confirmation, and a receiving scan that matches asset tag and serial number. Serial mismatches remain unresolved custody even if a label exists.

6. Receiving exceptions

Shipment serial mismatches, damaged parcels, and dock exception photos are investigative leads. An exception image does not clear custody or mark an asset Available.

7. Capitalization and ledger expectations

Capitalize individual assets with acquisition cost of \$2,500 or more. A purchase-order field marking `capitalization_approved = Yes` authorizes capital treatment only for qualifying lines at or above the per-asset threshold; it does not require or imply that under-threshold lines appear on the fixed-asset ledger. Absence of an under-threshold asset from the ledger is expected and is not a Critical inventory-to-ledger certification blocker. Absence of a qualifying ($\geq$ \$2,500) asset from the ledger is a Critical finance exception that blocks certification until capitalized or formally written off.

8. Disposal and media sanitization

Retirement requires an approved disposal path and a verified disposal certificate matching tag/serial (`certificate_verified = Yes`). Sanitization should align with NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 2. Recycler transfers without verified certificates remain Retired/Pending Disposal operationally even if the ledger already shows Disposed.

9. Financial reconciliation

Reconcile operational inventory to the fixed-asset ledger each quarter. Explain every remaining difference class. Acquisition cost mismatches that are systematic but below \$500 per asset require Finance remediation and do not alone block certification. Critical blockers are unresolved custody of capital assets, overdue returns without receiving proof, shipment serial mismatches, missing disposal certificates for retired assets, and missing ledger rows for assets at or above the capitalization threshold.

10. Certification

The IT Operations Manager certifies the quarterly inventory only when Critical blockers are cleared or formally accepted by Finance and Internal Audit. HR validates employment status used in custody decisions. Internal Audit may test any custody chain.

11. Evidence and retention

Evidence must identify the asset tag, serial number where applicable, transaction ID, date, and source system. Technician notes and images are retained as leads with the reconciliation package.

Appendix A — Control Matrix (figure)

Read with the narrative controls above. Severity for certification follows \$7–\$9.

Meridian Data Services — ITAM-001 Appendix A Control Matrix			
Effective with Policy ITAM-001. Read with the narrative controls.			
Control	Required Evidence	Failure Classification	Owner
Assignment	Employee ID + tag + serial + acknowledgement	Unverified custody	IT Asset Specialist
Transfer	Transfer ID + approval + receipt	Unapproved transfer	IT Operations Manager
Return	Carrier acceptance + delivery + receiving scan	Overdue / shipment mismatch	IT Asset Specialist
Disposal	Retirement approval + sanitization + certificate	Missing disposal evidence	IT Asset Manager
Financial	PO + register + ledger agreement	Inventory-to-ledger difference	Finance Controller
Use with IT_asset_management_policy.pdf. Informal notes cannot override this evidence standard.			

Appendix B — Public Benchmark Sources

- NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5 — Security and Privacy Controls
- NIST SP 800-88 Rev. 2 — Media Sanitization
- IRS Publication 946 — How To Depreciate Property